

# Voynich Manuscript — Iconographic Catalogue of the Herbal & Pharmaceutical Plants

Visual-morphology analysis of ~136 plant folios (Beinecke MS 408). This is iconography, NOT decipherment.

22 June 2026

## What this is, and what it is not

This catalogue records the **visual morphology** of every plant drawing in the herbal and pharmaceutical sections of the manuscript: growth habit, leaf form, flower, and root, plus a judgement of botanical realism and — only where a non-specialist would clearly recognise it — a **speculative, visual-only** candidate genus. Six independent analysts each examined a block of pages.

It is essential to be clear about the limits:

- **This is not decoding.** The Voynichese text beside each plant is undeciphered; there is no caption to confirm any identification. Nothing here reads the script.
- **Identification is mostly impossible by design.** The plants are overwhelmingly **stylised or chimeric** — a plausible leaf grafted onto an invented flower and, very often, a botanically impossible root. Such composites do not correspond to any single real species.
- **Every candidate is a hypothesis, not a fact.** Each is tagged [SPECULATIVE - visual only]. Per a strict no-fabrication standard, the candidate column was left blank wherever there was no clear resemblance — which is the large majority of pages. Latin names were never invented to fill space.

## Aggregate result (≈136 plant folios)

| Realism class           | Count (approx.) | Meaning                                                                        |
|-------------------------|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| REALISTIC               | ~4              | Parts form a botanically coherent real plant (e.g. p-061, p-093, p-107, p-118) |
| STYLISTED-but-plausible | ~100            | Recognisable plant architecture, but no secure species                         |
| COMPOSITE-CHIMERA       | ~29             | Impossible combination (e.g. octopus/animal-shaped or segmented roots)         |
| UNIDENTIFIABLE          | ~3              | Too faded or abstract to assess (p-039, p-095, p-098)                          |

**Only ~9 of ~136 folios (~7%) showed even a tentative, lay-recognisable resemblance to a real genus**, and not one is confident. The candidates flagged were: Viola (p-020), an Asteraceae-type daisy (p-029), Centaurea (p-033), Geranium/Aconitum (p-045), Daucus/carrot (p-082, p-117, p-165), Myosotis (p-094), and Aquilegia (p-113) — all [SPECULATIVE - visual only].

A recurring and telling feature: **the roots are the least realistic element**. Many are frankly fantastical — splayed “octopus” arms (p-110, p-159, p-180, p-182), segmented caterpillar-like rhizomes (p-036, p-044), looped/knotted forms (p-103), or roots drawn as **animals** with legs and tails (p-166). Small creatures are also tucked into roots and crowns on p-050, p-054, p-055 (octopus-like), p-058, and p-068. This dominance of impossible underground organs is itself strong evidence that the herbal is not a faithful botanical record but a stylised or invented one — exactly why a century of identification attempts (O’Neill’s “sunflower,” Tucker’s “Mexican plants”) has failed.

## Catalogue — main herbal section

### Pages 3-25

| Page | Habit              | Leaf                            | Flower                                     | Root                             | Realism   | Candidate |
|------|--------------------|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------|-----------|
| 3    | herb, small sprig  | green ovate leaflets, entire    | small red buds                             | not shown                        | stylised  | —         |
| 4    | herb, upright      | ovate, opposite, green/tan      | round red berries                          | branching/fibrous                | stylised  | —         |
| 5    | herb, spreading    | palmately divided, lobed        | pale pom-pom heads (thistle/scabious-like) | slender reddish taproot          | stylised  | —         |
| 6    | herb, rosette      | one large reniform leaf, basal  | none                                       | thin taproot                     | stylised  | —         |
| 7    | herb, upright      | pinnate, red-green striped      | none distinct                              | stout orange carrot-like taproot | stylised  | —         |
| 8    | vine/herb, arching | spiky star leaves, lobed        | two dark-blue hooded flowers               | horizontal orange tuber          | composite | —         |
| 9    | herb, two spikes   | fine feathery pinnate           | many tiny red bell florets                 | fibrous                          | stylised  | —         |
| 10   | herb, single stem  | feathery pinnate, dissected     | one blue star flower                       | bulbous brown tuber              | composite | —         |
| 11   | herb, low          | large lobed rounded leaf, basal | small whitish form                         | slender pale taproot             | stylised  | —         |
| 12   | herb, multi-stem   | ivy-like 3-5 lobed              | small red star flowers                     | fibrous                          | stylised  | —         |
| 13   | herb, upright      | pinnatifid fern-like, basal     | drooping red-tipped bells                  | fibrous                          | stylised  | —         |
| 14   | herb, branching    | palmate (5-7 seg), whorled      | blue pincushion/burr heads                 | fibrous tuft                     | stylised  | —         |

| Page | Habit              | Leaf                          | Flower                                 | Root                    | Realism   | Candidate                  |
|------|--------------------|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-------------------------|-----------|----------------------------|
| 15   | herb, radial top   | linear leaves in 8-pt whorl   | foliar rosette                         | reddish forked base     | stylised  | —                          |
| 16   | herb, spreading    | elliptic dotted, opposite     | red-orange pod                         | not shown               | stylised  | —                          |
| 17   | herb, single leaf  | maple-like incised leaf       | none                                   | thin red forked taproot | stylised  | —                          |
| 18   | herb, tall         | pinnate, opposite             | small red/blue buds                    | thin base               | stylised  | —                          |
| 19   | herb, bushy        | spiky palmate, red petioles   | red-brown floret spike                 | branching fibrous mass  | stylised  | —                          |
| 20   | herb, branched     | lanceolate, alternate         | blue 5-petal flowers, face-like centre | branching fibrous       | stylised  | <b>Viola sp.</b><br>[SPEC] |
| 21   | herb, two stems    | lanceolate brown-edged        | blue cornflower-like head              | two red bulb forms      | stylised  | —                          |
| 22   | herb, twin arching | strap leaves spiralling       | blue bell-flower clusters              | shared root base        | stylised  | —                          |
| 23   | herb, multi-stem   | small, obscured               | hemispherical blue floret mound        | thin runners            | stylised  | —                          |
| 24   | tree/shrub         | scale-like green/orange crown | blue tuft apex                         | splayed root-foot       | composite | —                          |
| 25   | herb, leafy crown  | scalloped lobed, alternate    | blue tuft                              | huge bulb + red taproot | composite | —                          |

## Pages 26-48

| Page | Habit              | Leaf                      | Flower                      | Root              | Realism  | Candidate                        |
|------|--------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------|----------|----------------------------------|
| 26   | two small plants   | ovate, lobed, dark-banded | blue/yellow buds            | splayed fibrous   | stylised | —                                |
| 27   | herb, basal leaves | lanceolate, red midribs   | reddish tuft                | fibrous clump     | stylised | —                                |
| 28   | herb, feathery     | finely pinnate            | pale florets                | reddish branching | stylised | —                                |
| 29   | herb, single stem  | pinnately lobed           | terminal daisy head, radial | reddish taproot   | stylised | <b>Asteraceae-type</b><br>[SPEC] |
| 30   | herb, low          | large cordate, entire     | none                        | fibrous reddish   | stylised | —                                |
| 31   | herb, tall         | palmate compound          | pink raceme                 | stout red taproot | stylised | —                                |

| Page | Habit                      | Leaf                                | Flower                                     | Root                                             | Realism               | Candidate                           |
|------|----------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------------------|
| 32   | herb,<br>flowers only      | absent/ghosted                      | blue star +<br>4 red<br>radiate<br>flowers | bulb/claw<br>base                                | stylised              | —                                   |
| 33   | herb,<br>frond-like        | pinnate,<br>opposite                | three dark<br>blue tufted<br>heads         | fibrous<br>reddish                               | stylised              | <b>Centaurea<br/>sp. [SPEC]</b>     |
| 34   | herb,<br>arching           | ovate-<br>lanceolate,<br>opposite   | pink catkin<br>spikes                      | pale<br>taproot                                  | stylised              | —                                   |
| 35   | herb, tall                 | pinnate,<br>oval leaflets           | blue floret<br>cluster                     | fibrous<br>reddish                               | stylised              | —                                   |
| 36   | herb, bushy                | 3-lobed<br>clover-like              | white tuft                                 | segmented<br>caterpillar<br>rhizome              | stylised              | —                                   |
| 37   | herb,<br>drooping          | pinnate/lanceolate                  | large blue<br>lily flower                  | finger-like<br>fleshy roots                      | stylised              | —                                   |
| 38   | tree/shrub                 | needle-like<br>feathery             | none                                       | stout red<br>taproot                             | stylised              | —                                   |
| 39   | herb, faded<br>clumps      | fine pinnate                        | pink florets                               | unclear                                          | <b>unidentifiable</b> | —                                   |
| 40   | herb,<br>arching<br>stems  | linear<br>grass-like,<br>basal      | blue thistle<br>heads                      | fibrous<br>base                                  | stylised              | —                                   |
| 41   | herb,<br>pinwheel          | pinnate in<br>radiating<br>sprays   | none clear                                 | central,<br>unclear                              | composite             | —                                   |
| 42   | herb,<br>whorled           | sickle<br>leaves,<br>opposite       | blue floret<br>cluster                     | bulb/knob<br>base                                | stylised              | —                                   |
| 43   | herb,<br>branching         | 3-lobed<br>clover-like              | blue berries<br>+ red spike                | branching<br>reddish                             | stylised              | —                                   |
| 44   | herb,<br>robust            | broad<br>obovate,<br>opposite       | bird-like<br>tuft                          | thorny<br>horizontal<br>rhizome<br>(fantastical) | composite             | —                                   |
| 45   | herb,<br>multi-stem        | palmate<br>(geranium-<br>like)      | blue 5-pt<br>star flowers                  | segmented<br>rhizome                             | stylised              | <b>Geranium/Aconitum<br/>[SPEC]</b> |
| 46   | herb,<br>paired<br>leaves  | ovate-<br>cordate,<br>opposite      | white star +<br>blue bud                   | branching<br>reddish                             | stylised              | —                                   |
| 47   | herb, leafy                | lanceolate-<br>hastate              | pale daisy<br>head                         | fibrous<br>mass                                  | stylised              | —                                   |
| 48   | herb,<br>rounded<br>leaves | reniform-<br>spatulate,<br>opposite | blue bell<br>florets                       | branching<br>reddish                             | stylised              | —                                   |

## Pages 49-70

| Page | Habit             | Leaf                           | Flower                      | Root                                | Realism          | Candidate |
|------|-------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------|------------------|-----------|
| 49   | herb, upright     | broad ovate, whorled           | small white cluster         | branching reddish                   | stylised         | —         |
| 50   | herb, rosette     | palmate star-burst, basal      | none                        | thin reddish; <b>animal at root</b> | stylised         | —         |
| 51   | herb, spreading   | cordate crenate, long petioles | dark berry clusters         | forked reddish taproot              | stylised         | —         |
| 52   | herb, spreading   | pinnate fern-like, opposite    | nodding blue bells          | long reddish branching              | stylised         | —         |
| 53   | herb, upright     | broad lanceolate, opposite     | flower sprig + 2nd sprig    | thin twisted pale                   | stylised         | —         |
| 54   | herb, upright     | pinnate serrate, opposite      | white daisies, red centres  | <b>two animals at base</b>          | composite        | —         |
| 55   | herb, single leaf | large striped palmate lobe     | none clear                  | <b>red octopus-like creature</b>    | composite        | —         |
| 56   | herb, upright     | dissected feathery, whorled    | white frilled cluster       | reddish branching                   | stylised         | —         |
| 57   | herb, drooping    | broad lobed ruffled, opposite  | red berry cluster           | fine pale rootlets                  | stylised         | —         |
| 58   | herb, rosette     | strap/hand-shaped, basal       | none clear                  | <b>row of animals at base</b>       | composite        | —         |
| 59   | herb, sprawling   | narrow lanceolate, opposite    | dark berry/catkin           | off-page                            | stylised         | —         |
| 60   | herb, upright     | pinnate serrate, olive         | beaded bud chain            | unclear                             | stylised         | —         |
| 61   | herb, upright     | broad ovate crenate, alternate | white/pink umbels           | massive spreading taproot           | <b>realistic</b> | —         |
| 62   | herb/shrub        | fir-like chevron foliage       | grey puffs + orange tufts   | thin pale                           | composite        | —         |
| 63   | herb, bushy       | ovate crenate, opposite        | spherical blue-violet heads | thin fibrous                        | stylised         | —         |
| 64   | herb, upright     | 5-pt star leaves, whorled      | blue lily-like flowers      | pale tuberous forked                | stylised         | —         |
| 65   | herb, upright     | broad ovate serrate, opposite  | two green pinwheel discs    | branching reddish                   | stylised         | —         |

| Page | Habit                       | Leaf                                      | Flower                                                 | Root                        | Realism   | Candidate |
|------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------|-----------|
| 66   | paired herb                 | dissected<br>frilly<br>rosettes           | two<br>blue-gold<br>sunbursts                          | branching<br>reddish        | composite | —         |
| 67   | herb,<br>rosette            | deeply<br>lobed<br>jagged,<br>basal       | grey<br>globular<br>heads                              | stout<br>reddish<br>taproot | stylised  | —         |
| 68   | tree,<br>spreading<br>crown | small<br>rounded<br>leaflets              | green/brown<br>ball-fruits;<br><b>animals in crown</b> | thick<br>reddish<br>mass    | composite | —         |
| 69   | herb,<br>upright            | olive<br>sheath/bract                     | curled<br>blue-pink<br>plume                           | pale bulb<br>base           | composite | —         |
| 70   | herb, tall                  | small<br>rounded<br>leaflets,<br>opposite | tiny red<br>berry-dots                                 | reddish<br>branching        | stylised  | —         |

## Pages 71-93

| Page | Habit                 | Leaf                                 | Flower                              | Root                            | Realism   | Candidate |
|------|-----------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------|-----------|-----------|
| 71   | herb, bushy           | palmately<br>dissected,<br>toothed   | pale cream<br>florets               | branching<br>fibrous            | stylised  | —         |
| 72   | herb,<br>sparse       | palmate<br>~7-lobed<br>star          | tiny brown<br>buds                  | orange-<br>brown<br>fibrous     | stylised  | —         |
| 73   | herb,<br>upright      | lanceolate,<br>whorled               | pink-red<br>floret<br>cluster       | brown<br>taproot                | stylised  | —         |
| 74   | herb, stout<br>stem   | oblong,<br>ladder-<br>pinnate        | dark blue<br>bud tips               | oversized<br>bulbous<br>taproot | stylised  | —         |
| 75   | herb, single<br>spike | one spotted<br>fern leaf             | none clear                          | fibrous<br>reddish              | stylised  | —         |
| 76   | herb, dense           | rhomboid<br>variegated,<br>alternate | one blue<br>aster flower            | thin reddish<br>taproot         | stylised  | —         |
| 77   | herb, clump           | lanceolate,<br>basal                 | blue<br>coronet<br>flower           | horizontal<br>rootstock         | stylised  | —         |
| 78   | herb,<br>upright      | pinnate,<br>opposite                 | two purple<br>star-bursts           | branching<br>orange<br>taproot  | stylised  | —         |
| 79   | herb, single<br>stem  | feathery<br>plumose,<br>whorled      | blue radial<br>sunburst             | fibrous<br>reddish              | stylised  | —         |
| 80   | herb, two<br>stems    | bushy,<br>lobed                      | ornate<br>blue-white<br>ringed disc | orange<br>onion-bulbs           | composite | —         |

| Page | Habit                                                  | Leaf                            | Flower                   | Root                             | Realism          | Candidate            |
|------|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------------------|------------------|----------------------|
| 81   | herb, tall                                             | hand-like feathery, alternate   | tiny green tufts         | two fused tuber lobes            | stylised         | —                    |
| 82   | herb, leafy                                            | dissected fern-like             | flat-topped dotted umbel | two forked red taproots          | stylised         | <b>Daucus</b> [SPEC] |
| 83   | herb, sparse                                           | one broad ovate leaf            | red/orange flowers       | root unclear                     | stylised         | —                    |
| 84   | herb, rosette                                          | broad ovate, whorled            | none                     | thin reddish fibrous             | stylised         | —                    |
| 85   | <i>non-herbal (biological — nude figures in basin)</i> | —                               | —                        | —                                | —                | —                    |
| 86   | herb, multi-stem                                       | narrow sickle, whorled          | green hooked florets     | thin roots; <b>serpent motif</b> | composite        | —                    |
| 87   | herb, drooping crown                                   | strap/sword, blue-green striped | pink tubular flower      | large pink-red taproot           | stylised         | —                    |
| 88   | herb, upright                                          | deeply lobed frilly, alternate  | pale pink flowers        | pale forked taproot              | stylised         | —                    |
| 89   | herb, clumped                                          | holly-like spiny + yellow bells | yellow pendant bells     | pale fibrous tubes               | stylised         | —                    |
| 90   | herb, two stems                                        | oval-elliptic, opposite         | blue floret clusters     | nodular beaded rhizome           | stylised         | —                    |
| 91   | herb, row of stems                                     | curved sickle, tiered/whorled   | pale pink-white buds     | fibrous fringe                   | stylised         | —                    |
| 92   | herb, basal clump                                      | finely divided fern-like, basal | domed honeycomb umbel    | red-tinged fibrous               | stylised         | —                    |
| 93   | herb, spreading                                        | two palmate/ivy lobed leaves    | none                     | none shown                       | <b>realistic</b> | —                    |

### Pages 94-120 (herbal pages only)

| Page | Habit             | Leaf                     | Flower                      | Root                 | Realism               | Candidate              |
|------|-------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|
| 94   | herb, single stem | broad ovate, opposite    | 5 small blue radial flowers | forked brown taproot | stylised              | <b>Myosotis</b> [SPEC] |
| 95   | herb, sprawling   | small palmate/digitate   | none                        | faint fibrous        | <b>unidentifiable</b> | —                      |
| 96   | herb, two stems   | lobed/pinnatifid toothed | none clear                  | not shown            | stylised              | —                      |

| Page | Habit              | Leaf                              | Flower                     | Root                               | Realism               | Candidate                  |
|------|--------------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------|
| 97   | tree, thick trunk  | rounded crown masses              | red/blue flecks            | bulbous stem-base                  | composite             | —                          |
| 98   | herb, single stalk | ruffled convoluted leaf-mass      | none                       | thin pale taproot                  | <b>unidentifiable</b> | —                          |
| 99   | herb, rosette      | pinnate blue-green, whorled       | blue spiky composite head  | orange-red fibrous mass            | stylised              | —                          |
| 100  | herb, upright      | broad rounded, opposite           | dark-blue filament cluster | spreading reddish                  | composite             | —                          |
| 101  | herb, single stem  | spiny blue-green, opposite        | 3 pink heads (umbel)       | crossed forked orange taproot      | stylised              | —                          |
| 102  | herb, tall spike   | twining narrow leaves             | blue spike inflorescence   | pale taproot                       | stylised              | —                          |
| 103  | herb, clumps       | narrow lanceolate, whorled        | blue-grey flowers          | <b>red looped/knotted rhizome</b>  | composite             | —                          |
| 104  | herb, tall         | spiny holly-like, alternate       | none clear                 | small reddish branching            | stylised              | —                          |
| 105  | herb, branched     | spiny toothed, opposite           | round burr seed-heads      | ring/coil shapes                   | composite             | —                          |
| 106  | herb, single stem  | palmate divided, alternate        | blue-red radial head       | short pale fibrous                 | stylised              | —                          |
| 107  | herb, tall arching | many ovate leaflets, pinnate-like | tiny grey head             | branching fibrous taproot          | <b>realistic</b>      | —                          |
| 108  | herb, arching      | lanceolate, alternate             | drooping blue bells        | <b>chain of red bead tubers</b>    | composite             | —                          |
| 109  | herb, tufts        | rounded scalloped, basal          | 3 red buds, blue dots      | pot-like mound base                | stylised              | —                          |
| 110  | herb, single stalk | large blue-green ruffled fan      | pale composite head        | <b>octopus-like multi-arm root</b> | composite             | —                          |
| 111  | herb, branched     | needle/feather sprays             | dark-blue pinwheel flowers | thin pale                          | stylised              | —                          |
| 112  | herb, single stalk | feathery pinnate fan              | tiny dark head             | pale swollen base                  | stylised              | —                          |
| 113  | herb, bushy        | palmate divided, alternate        | blue nodding bells         | thin pale                          | stylised              | <b>Aquilegia</b><br>[SPEC] |



| Page | Habit             | Leaf                        | Flower                 | Root                    | Realism          | Candidate            |
|------|-------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------|------------------|----------------------|
| 117  | herb, bushy       | deeply lobed pinnatifid     | pale star-flowers      | red carrot-like fingers | stylised         | <b>Daucus</b> [SPEC] |
| 118  | herb, airy        | tiny clustered leaflets     | blue flower + buds     | fibrous spreading       | <b>realistic</b> | —                    |
| 120  | herb, single stem | pinnate fern-like, opposite | two blue-white flowers | red forked taproot      | stylised         | —                    |

## Catalogue — later herbal & pharmaceutical section

The “pharmaceutical” pages depict **detached plant parts** (cut roots, leaves, sprigs) arranged in rows beside ornate cylindrical apothecary jars — the layout of a remedy reference rather than a field herbal.

| Page | Type        | Parts / habit                                 | Flower                 | Root                                     | Realism   | Candidate                     |
|------|-------------|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------|------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------------------------|
| 159  | whole plant | broad palmate lobed leaves                    | feathery sprig         | massive octopus-like taproot             | composite | —                             |
| 160  | whole (×2)  | fern fronds + round leaf                      | reddish feathery       | twin carrot/parsnip taproots             | stylised  | —                             |
| 161  | pharma      | rows of rootlets/sprigs + 3 banded jars       | none                   | detached fibrous/tuberous                | stylised  | —                             |
| 162  | pharma      | rows of roots/sprigs + tiered jars            | none                   | detached fibrous                         | stylised  | —                             |
| 163  | pharma      | detached roots, tendrils, leaves + blue jars  | none                   | sprawling branching roots                | stylised  | —                             |
| 164  | pharma      | jars + berry-cluster plant + round-leaf sprig | dark blue berries      | detached fibrous                         | stylised  | —                             |
| 165  | whole plant | pinnate narrow leaflets                       | two white umbel heads  | branching carrot-like taproot            | stylised  | <b>Daucus/Achillea</b> [SPEC] |
| 166  | whole plant | large pinnate toothed                         | dark star flowers      | <b>root shaped as a quadruped animal</b> | composite | —                             |
| 167  | whole plant | broad oval, ladder-paired                     | beige dotted dome head | fine reddish fibrous                     | stylised  | —                             |

| Page | Type        | Parts / habit                                   | Flower                   | Root                                | Realism   | Candidate |
|------|-------------|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------------|-----------|-----------|
| 168  | whole plant | spiky star whorls                               | red berry cluster        | pale tubers/bulbs                   | stylised  | —         |
| 169  | whole plant | scalloped leaflets, arching                     | blue berry spike         | reddish fibrous                     | stylised  | —         |
| 170  | whole (×3)  | tufted, leafy, grassy                           | blue buds                | taproot + fibrous clumps            | stylised  | —         |
| 171  | whole plant | few 3-lobed toothed                             | white umbel/corymb       | forked red-brown taproot            | stylised  | —         |
| 172  | whole plant | finely divided feathery                         | ring of blue dot-flowers | broad red swollen base              | stylised  | —         |
| 173  | whole plant | spiky star whorls                               | dotted dome head         | conical fibrous root                | stylised  | —         |
| 174  | whole (×2)  | triangular arrowhead                            | drooping red catkins     | small brown taproot                 | stylised  | —         |
| 175  | pharma      | rows of roots/sprigs + red jars + striped tuber | none                     | fibrous tangles                     | stylised  | —         |
| 176  | pharma      | rows + tiered jars + leafy plant                | none                     | fibrous; <b>animal-like root</b>    | composite | —         |
| 177  | pharma      | detached fan/oval/lobed leaves + red jars       | none                     | small fibrous                       | stylised  | —         |
| 178  | pharma      | dense rows of varied leaves + small jars        | small blue sprig         | few detached roots                  | stylised  | —         |
| 179  | pharma      | varied leaves + tall banded jars + leafy plant  | pale sprig               | few detached rootlets               | stylised  | —         |
| 180  | pharma      | rows + central plant + red jars                 | none                     | fibrous; <b>orange octopus root</b> | composite | —         |
| 181  | pharma      | leaf sprigs + blue crown motifs + tall jar      | blue coronet motifs      | pale sprawling fibrous              | stylised  | —         |
| 182  | pharma      | rows of roots/sprigs + banded jars              | none                     | <b>orange octopus/animal roots</b>  | composite | —         |

## Bottom line

Across roughly 136 plant folios, the honest yield is: about four genuinely realistic drawings, a large majority of recognisable-but-unplaceable stylised plants, and around thirty outright botanical impossibilities — concentrated, tellingly, in the roots. Fewer than one in ten folios offers even a tentative visual resemblance to a real genus, and none is secure. This pattern is not a failure of effort; it is a property of the manuscript. The herbal was not drawn as an accurate botanical record, which is why neither this analysis nor any prior one can deliver a verified species list — and why no honest analyst should claim to.